

Building the CPD App – From Concept to Launch

Connecting competency, evidence and development planning in one mobile-ready platform



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Executive summary

As a Senior IT Programme Manager with 25 years of experience delivering complex digital programmes, I set out to build a modern Continuing Professional Development (CPD) application around a clear problem: CPD is essential, yet many available tools are outdated, fragmented and designed primarily for HR teams rather than individuals.

I designed the CPD App to help professionals and learners record development, connect activity to competency frameworks, capture evidence and plan their next steps within one integrated experience. The result is a mobile-ready platform designed for individual and institutional use, with a focus on simplicity, visual clarity and practical evidence of growth.

Project snapshot

At a glance

A CPD platform that brings competency, evidence and development planning together for professionals, students, apprentices, job-seekers, educators, employers and CPD providers.

Area	Summary
Product	CPD App
Role	Senior IT Programme Manager and product creator
Experience brought to the project	25 years delivering complex digital programmes
Build platform	Base44
Core proposition	Connect competency, CPD activity, evidence and development planning

The problem

Professionals, students, apprentices and job-seekers all need practical ways to evidence their skills and development. I found that traditional CPD systems were often administrative rather than developmental, rigid and compliance-driven, poorly designed for mobile use, disconnected from competency frameworks and not built for quick evidence capture.

I wanted to create a tool that was:

- **Simple** — Easy to understand and use.
- **Visual** — Making progress, strengths and gaps easier to see.
- **Mobile-friendly** — Suitable for recording development wherever it happens.
- **Competency-driven** — Connecting activity to professional capability.
- **Evidence-focused** — Making it easier to capture and organise proof of learning.
- **Exportable** — Supporting employers and educators with usable development information.

In framing the opportunity, I described current providers such as APM and BCS as offering a static CPD log and a competency framework with ratings for each competency. The gaps I identified were:

- No way to provide evidence to support CPD progress or competency ratings.
- No ability to identify or plan development needs, perform gap analysis or manage a development plan.
- No linkage between the CPD log and the competency framework.

The CPD App bridges these gaps by integrating these elements into a single, dynamic ecosystem. This became the foundation for the product.

Target audiences and market

The platform is positioned for four connected audiences:

Audience	Use case
Personal users	Professionals, students, apprentices and job-seekers tracking their own development.
CPD providers	Providers such as APM and BCS seeking more modern, integrated tools.
Education sector	Colleges and training providers supporting employability and skills evidence.
Employers	Organisations enabling performance reviews, appraisals and career development tracking.

Solution design

I structured the design around three connected pillars. Together, they create a coherent CPD experience in which users can see their capability, record activity and retain evidence of progress.

Pillar	Design approach
Competency mapping	A visual competency wheel aligned to professional frameworks including APM, BCS and PMI, helping users see strengths, gaps and development priorities.
CPD logging	A structured log for recording and categorising activities quickly, with the ability to link entries to competencies.
Evidence capture	A portfolio approach allowing users to upload documents, notes, links and proof of learning.

Core product features

The CPD App delivers a suite of features designed to support flexibility, automation and insight across the development lifecycle.

Feature	Purpose
Lifecycle framework	Visualises development stages.
CPD log	Supports import, reporting and AI-suggested entries, with links to competency, evidence and the development plan.
Competency ratings	Supports import and manual creation, reporting, AI-suggested links and manual links to CPD, evidence and development.
Dashboard	Provides metrics and KPIs for progress tracking.
Awards and badges	Provides automated recognition of milestones.
Gap analysis	Identifies competency gaps and suggests tasks.
Evidence vault	Securely stores and links evidence to CPD, the development plan and competency.
Development plan	Connects goals, CPD and evidence.
Career simulator	Compares a current role with a target role to define development targets.
To-do list	Supports actionable daily tracking.
Full reporting suite	Provides exportable insights for individuals and organisations.
Profile page	Creates a personalised summary of achievements.
Link to CV App	Integrates professional development with career documentation.

Building the application

Using the Base44 platform, I developed the core product experience, including:

- The full CPD logging system.
- Competency wheel visualisation.
- Evidence repository.
- User dashboard.
- Metrics and progress tracking.
- Exportable reports.
- Mobile-ready interface.

The build required careful UX planning, data modelling and iterative testing to ensure that the application was intuitive and fast.

Testing and iteration

I conducted multiple rounds of testing with a broad group of intended users and stakeholders:

- Professionals.
- Students.
- Apprenticeship learners.
- Project managers.
- Educators.

The feedback led to improvements in navigation, the evidence upload flow, competency scoring, dashboard clarity and mobile responsiveness. Through this process, the app evolved into a clean, modern and user-friendly tool.

Launch and early adoption

The CPD App is now being positioned for a range of individual and institutional use cases:

- Professionals maintaining CPD.
- Students evidencing skills.
- Apprentices tracking workplace learning.
- Colleges supporting employability.
- Project managers developing competency portfolios.

Early adopters have praised the simplicity, visual design and structured approach to development.

Future roadmap

Planned enhancements are intended to extend the platform's reach, accessibility and organisational value:

- **Corporate and personal packages** — Tailored pricing and functionality.
- **LinkedIn integration** — Sync achievements and competencies.
- **Badge level display** — Make badge levels visible on the profile page.
- **Social sharing** — Share badge progress on social media.
- **Light/dark mode toggle** — Improve accessibility and personalisation.
- **Calendar integration** — Scan Gmail and Outlook events for automatic CPD logging.
- **Professional-body integration** — Connect the platform with professional bodies.
- **College and apprenticeship dashboards** — Support education and apprenticeship oversight.
- **Team-based CPD management** — Extend development management to teams.
- **Enterprise licensing** — Support larger organisational adoption.

The platform is built to scale with low overheads and strong SaaS potential.

Strategic impact

The CPD App brings competency, evidence and development planning together in one intelligent system. By connecting these elements, it addresses the gaps I identified in more static and fragmented approaches to CPD management.

The product is scalable, mobile-ready and designed for both individual and institutional use. It supports professionals and learners in tracking growth, evidencing skills and progressing their careers, while giving educators, employers and CPD providers a more connected view of development.

The project also demonstrates the full product lifecycle: identifying a problem, shaping the proposition, designing the experience, building the application, testing with users, preparing for launch and defining a future roadmap.

Closing takeaway

The CPD App represents the culmination of my experience in professional development, digital delivery and user-centred design. I created it to solve a practical problem for real people: making it easier to record development, connect learning to competencies, retain evidence and plan meaningful next steps.

Key takeaway

The CPD App provides a structured, visual and evidence-focused way for professionals and learners to manage development, while creating a foundation for broader use across education, employers and CPD providers.



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